Glossary

1. Acute disease: A disease in which symptoms develop rapidly but lasts for only a short time.
2. Aseptic techniques: Laboratory techniques to minimize contamination.
3. Assimilation: The absorption and digestion of nutrients by any biological system.
4. Axenic: Pure cultures of micro organisms, which are not contaminated by any foreign organisms.
5. Base Stacking: Stacking implies vertical interactions between bases as they sit on top of one another.
6. Bio-augmentation: The use of pollutant acclimated microbes or genetically engineered microbes for bioremediation.
7. Coagulation: The action or process of a liquid, especially blood, changing to a solid or semi-solid state.
8. Coal-tar dyes: Liquid produced by distilling coal containing benzene naphthalene, phenols, aniline and many other organic chemical.
9. Coliforms: Aerobic or facultatively anaerobic, Gram negative, non endospore forming, rod shaped bacteria that ferment lactose with acid and gas formation within 48 hours at 350 °C.
10. Colony: A Colony is defined as a visible mass of microorganism all originating from a single mother cell.
11. Cover slip: A small, thin piece of glass used to cover and protect a specimen on a microscope slide.
12. Denaturation of DNA: Separation or unwinding of dsDNA strands into single strands.
13. Denature: To deprive something of its natural character and properties.
14. Depyrogenation: Removal of pyrogens from solutions mostly from injectable pharmaceuticals.
15. Dermatomycosis: A fungal infection of skin.
16. Diatomaceous earth: A soft, crumbly, porous sedimentary deposit formed from the fossil remains of diatoms.
17. DNA amplification: The production of multiple copies of a sequence of DNA.
18. Electromagnetic spectrum: The range of wavelengths or frequencies over which electromagnetic radiation extends.
19. Exudate: Low molecular weight metabolites that enter the soil from plant roots.
20. Flake: A small flat thin piece of which has broken away or been peeled from a larger piece.
21. Fluoresence: The property of absorbing light of short wave length and emitting light of longer wave length.
22. Folliculitis: An infection of hair follicles, often occurring as pimples.
23. Fulminating: A condition that develops quickly and rapidly increases in severity.
24. Furuncle: A pus filled, painful infection of a hair follicle.
25. Gene: A unit of heredity which is transferred from parent to progeny.
26. Genetic code: The mRNA codons and the amino acids they encode.
27. Genetics: The study of heredity and variation of inherited characteristics.
28. Genome: One complete copy of the genetic information in cell.

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